Tier pack: Independent route — Refining technique through structured critique

Pathway: SUMMIT · Week 4 Part 1 · Big question: How do we use criteria-led critique to test material refinements and resolve our final identity outcome?

Independent route studio steps

Step 1: Conduct a structured peer critique using the Four-Criteria matrix, recording specific strengths and one high-leverage refinement target.

Step 2: Execute a 6 cm live swatch testing your material adjustment (tonal glazing, counterchange sharpening, or opaque highlight lift).

Step 3: Resolve your final identity piece by applying the verified refinement and mounting it cleanly.

Step 4: Write a technical evaluation on your critique sheet linking your Week 1 target to today's final resolution.

Success check

Peer audit recorded, live swatch verified, final artwork resolved/mounted, and technical evaluation written.

Key words helper

• criteria-led critique: Evaluating an artwork against specific technical benchmarks rather than personal opinion.

• high-leverage: A focused change to a key area (like the focal contour or core shadow) that lifts the whole artwork.

• value contrast: The visual punch created by placing your darkest dark next to your brightest light.

• resolution: Bringing all parts of an artwork to a purposeful, cohesive finish.

• synthesis: Combining insights from skill trials, practitioner analysis, and critique into the final piece.

Review checklist

[ ] Step back two paces to view your resolved, mounted identity piece alongside your swatch log.

[ ] Verify that your critique card connects your Week 1 target to your Week 4 outcome.

[ ] Place your resolved work safely in the portfolio rack.